



STICKS & STONES

Jessie Grill

Art and Story

MAY BREAK MY BONES

STICKS AND STONES



BUT WORDS

WILL NEVER HURT ME



Ivy is born in 1972.



She lives on the East Coast of the U.S.A. and moves repeatedly.





Her first memories are gruesome.
It would appear that she has been left to fate.



At 3 years of age, Ivy knows what a secret is.



Her eyes are wild, her parents divorced.



Gifts came from Grandma



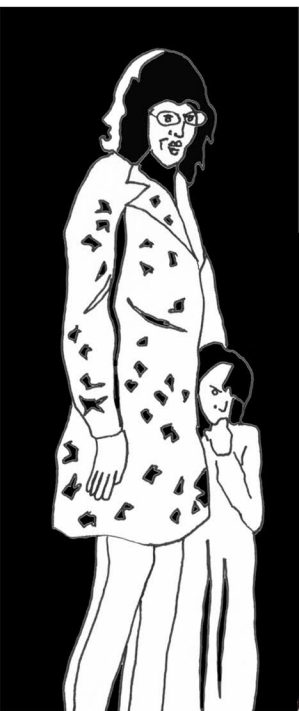
and her brother's old hand-me-downs, that eventually grew to fit.





Their mother was single and then she wasn't.





a stepfather came and stepmothers went.



Vivian goes with the flow. She loves the serenity of swimming with the fish



and the irony that she loves to eat them well cooked.



She thinks to herself

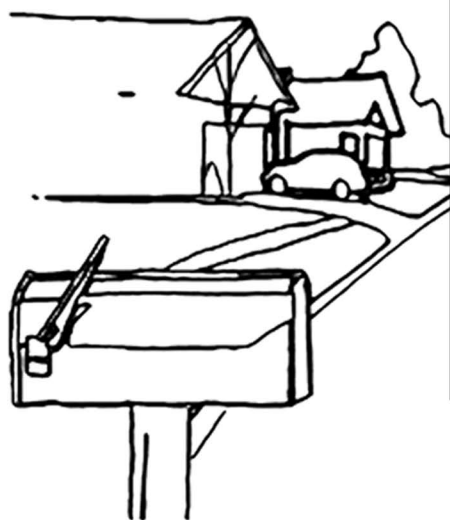


only boring people get bored



In 1978, Ivy now knows how to keep secrets.

She practises disassociation and astral projection.



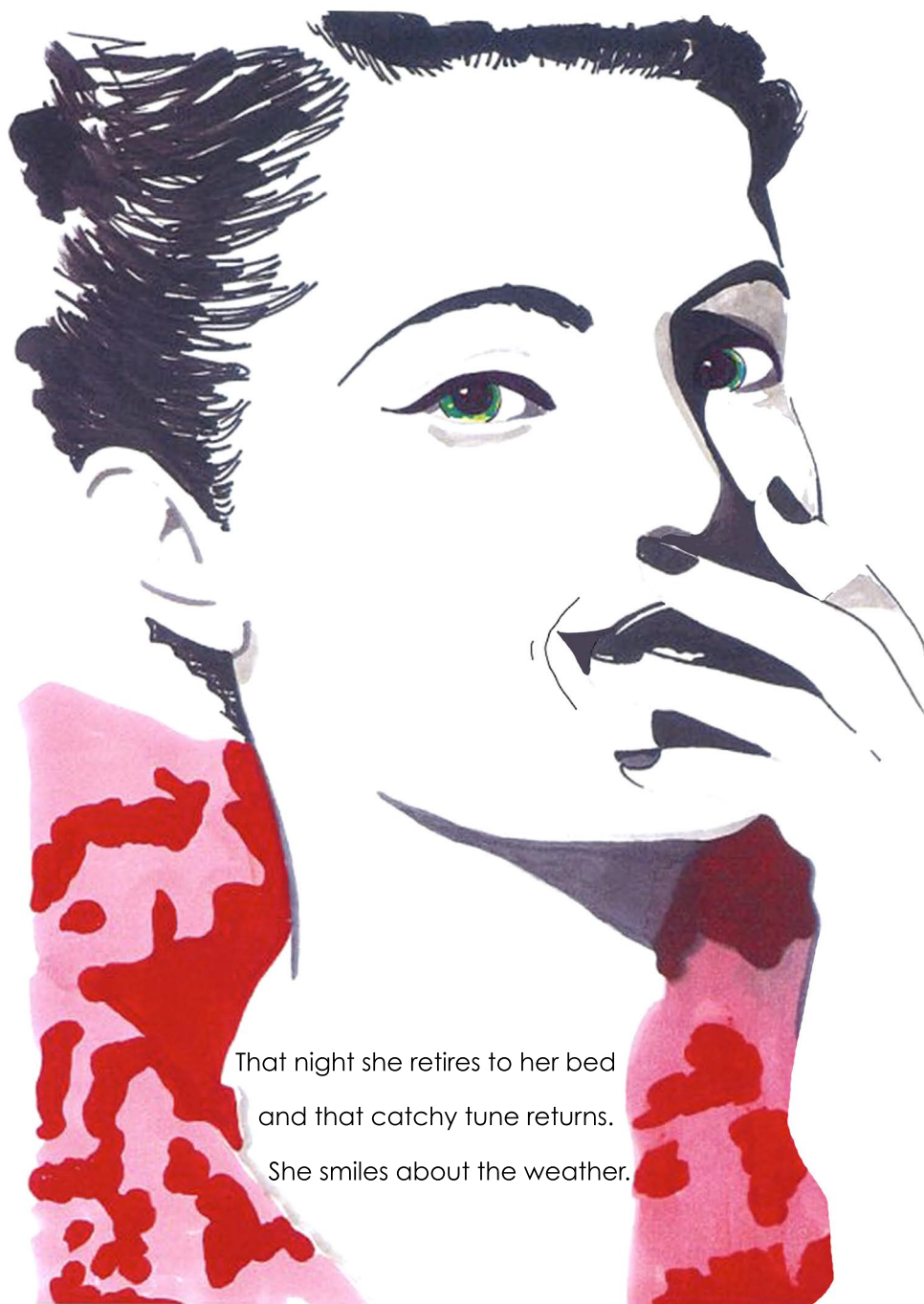
Vivian goes to the Quick Mart and shops for her dinner.



She hears a melancholy tune playing on the store's radio.

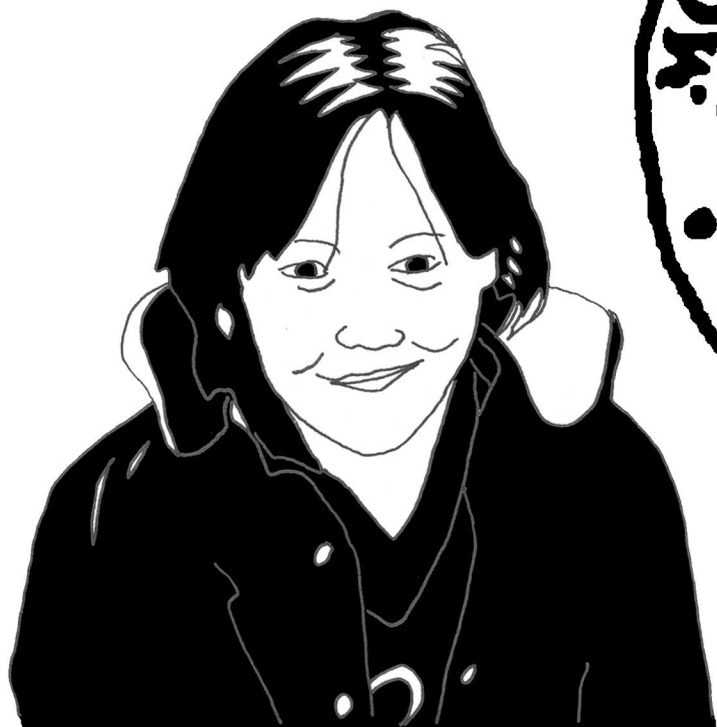
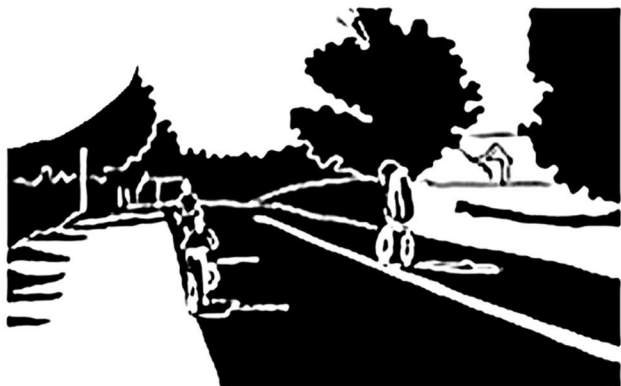


and remembers an evening back in July.



That night she retires to her bed
and that catchy tune returns.
She smiles about the weather.

The neighbor kids in 1982, where Ivy lives are wealthy.



She discovers the idea of boys at 10 years old.

Sex was always there, disguised as romantic radio songs,
introduced through masculinity and dishonesty.



This was the experience; questions lingered.

black out

fade to dream



THE DREAM

Ivy and Vivian notice each other





Vivian wakes up and reflects on her dream; Ivy does not.



With her coffee and feels a certain way.
She walks to the window.



She accepts not knowing and continues on with her day.



Vivian contemplates;



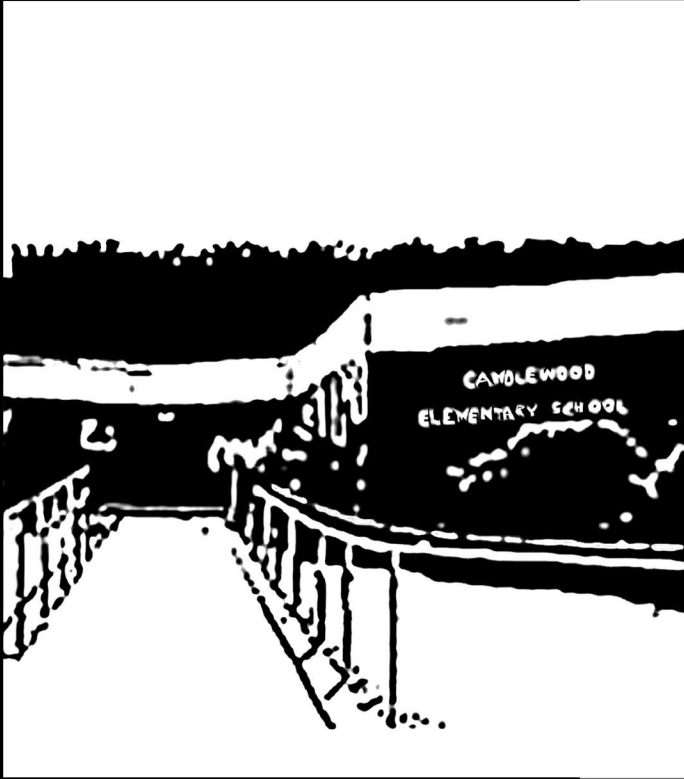
who or what is that girl



At age 16, Ivy drops out of high school.

She does the work and gets minimum wage.





She has moved over 11 times, and attended 9 different learning institutions;

1 kindergarten,
1 elementary school,
2 middle schools and
6 high schools.

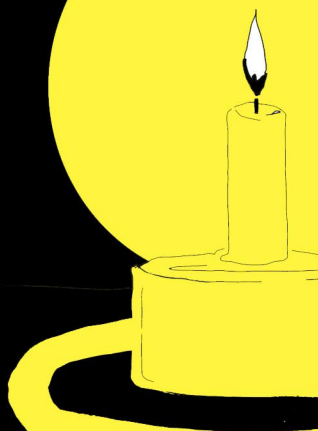


Not sure of how many times she has lost her mind already,
she thinks maybe she could count them on one hand.

Trusting no one, her secrets are the safest thing in her life.



Meditating, open, asking no questions, searching for no answers;

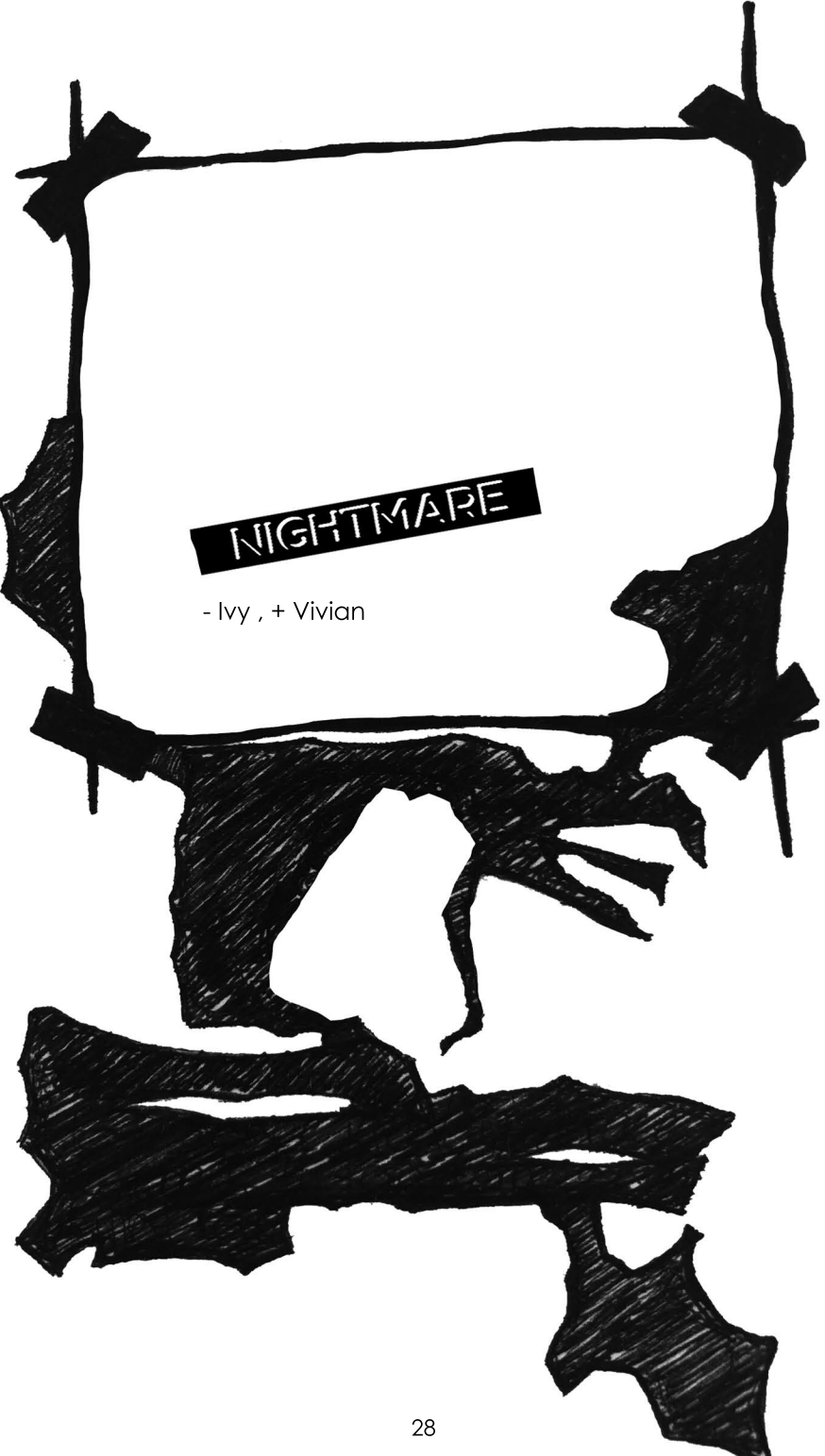


Vivian gets into the out, where gravity is an i
llusion.

She sits up and stops, the moment passes.



That night she goes to sleep wondering



NIGHTMARE

- Ivy , + Vivian



- THEY TOOK SOMETHING FROM ME

÷ WHO? WHO TOOK SOMETHING FROM YOU?

- THEY ALL TOOK IT

÷ WHAT DID THEY TAKE?

- SOMETHING I NEEDED, SOMETHING I THOUGHT I DIDN'T HAVE

÷ HOW MANY WERE THEY?

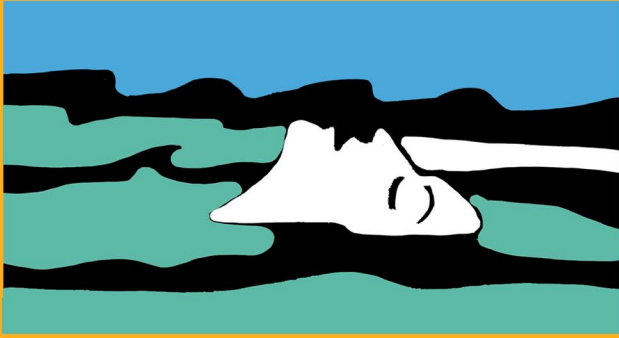
- THEY WERE MANY

÷ DID YOU GET IT BACK?

- NO IT'S GONE

Vivian is swimming again. She hears the message. She feels the pain.





Keeping her head above water, she floats on her back.

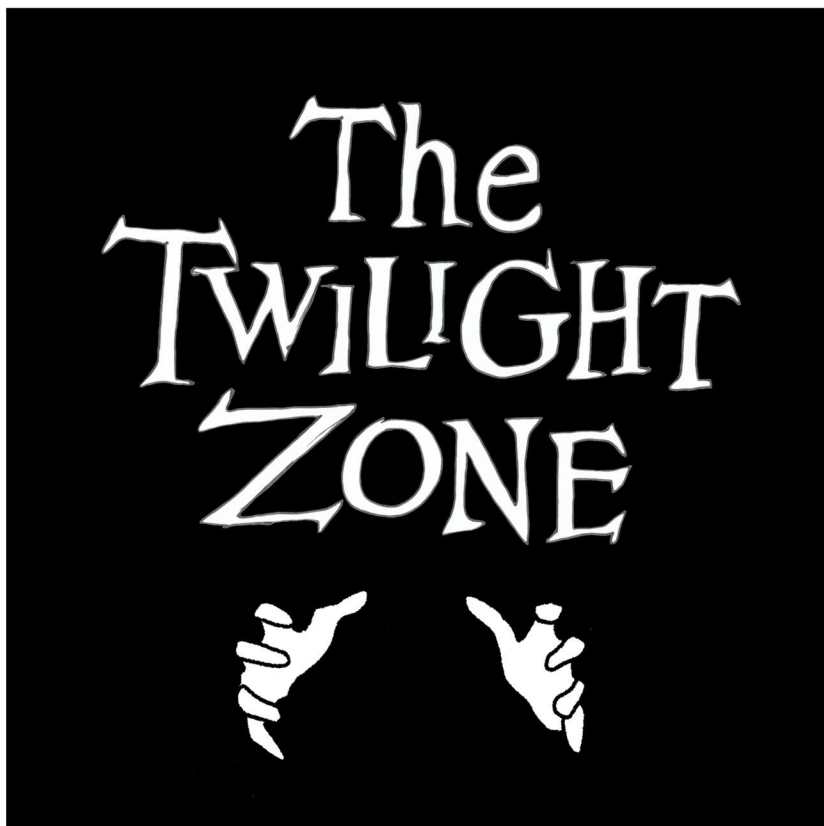


At the age of 18, Ivy has moved 13 times.

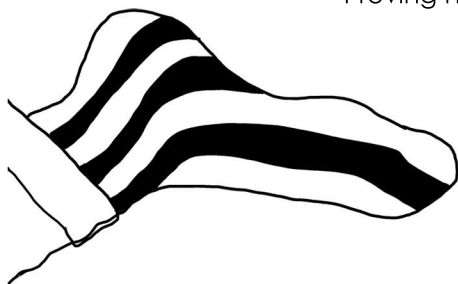


She has worked at least 6 dead end jobs.

She now uses 2 hands to count how many times she has lost her mind.



Proving herself

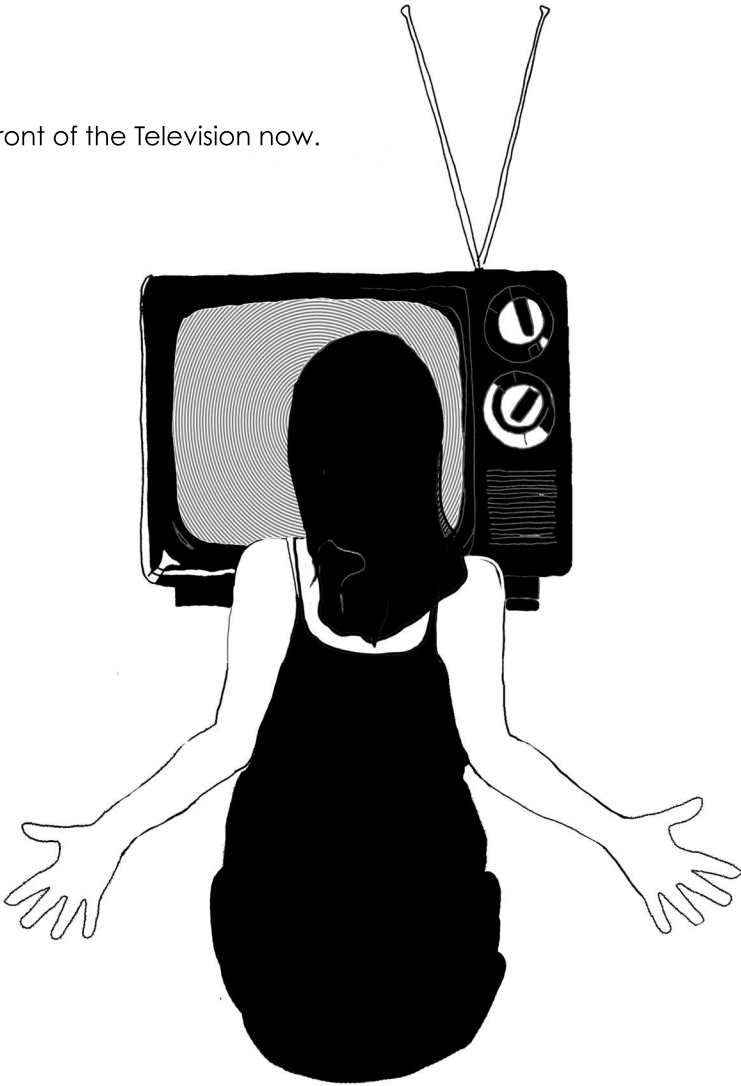


worthy of an education, she returns to her family base.

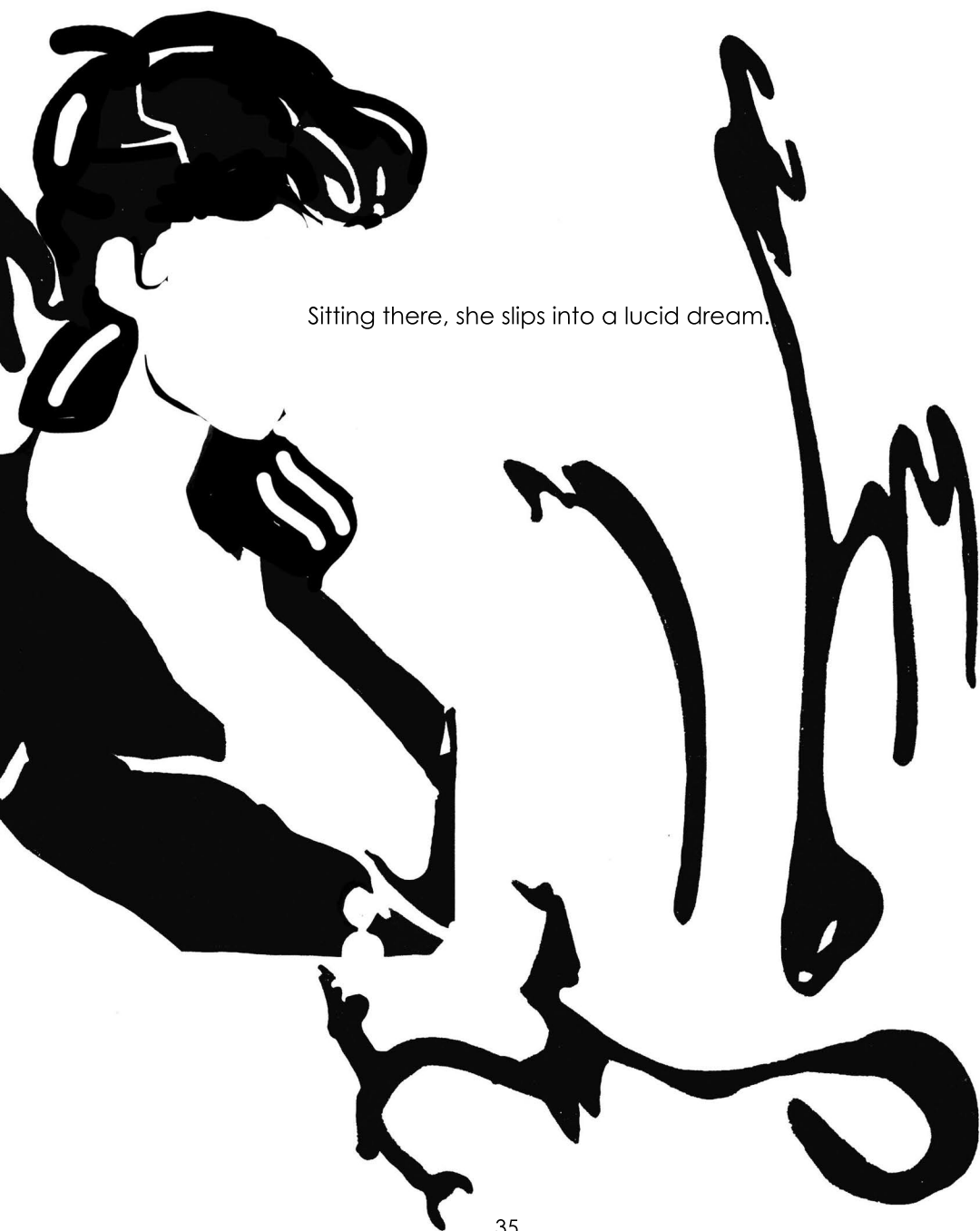
No learning is for free.

Vivian goes to the living room.

She is in front of the Television now.



She closes her eyes and listens to various channels, all at once, then turns it off.



Sitting there, she slips into a lucid dream.

The background is an abstract composition of various shades of green and blue. A large, bright blue triangular shape points towards the top right corner. Within and around this triangle are several organic, rounded green shapes of different sizes. The overall effect is a layered, painterly texture.

THE LUCID DREAM

- Ivy, and + Vivian recognize each other

+ what did you do?
- i felt short , so i stepped onto the box
+ where did you go?
- i was too high up, so i jumped down again
+ did you find space?
- i found emptiness - everything else was too loud
+ that's good; go there - take the stairs and turn left
- there is something there
+ i know



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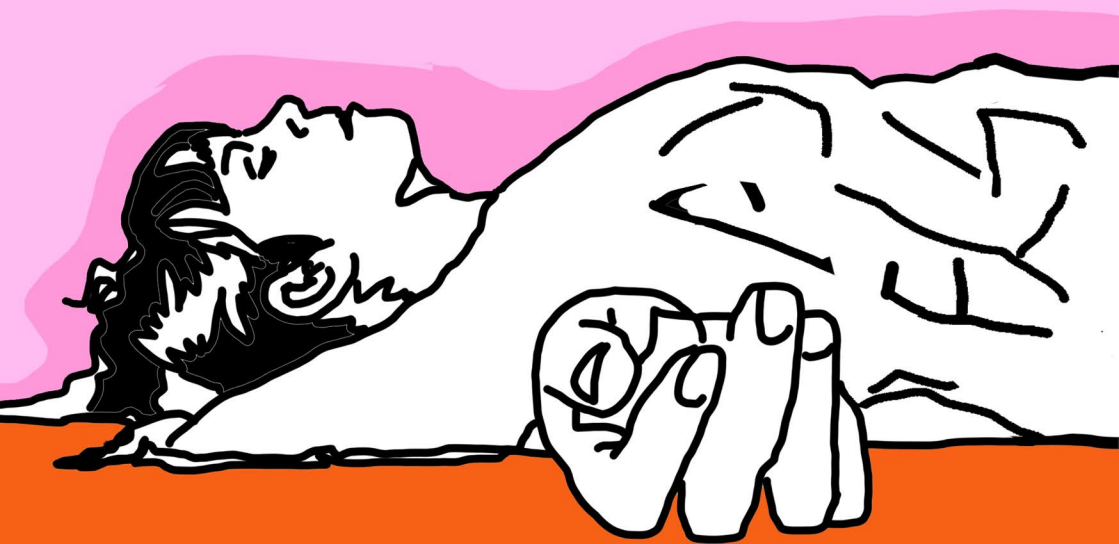
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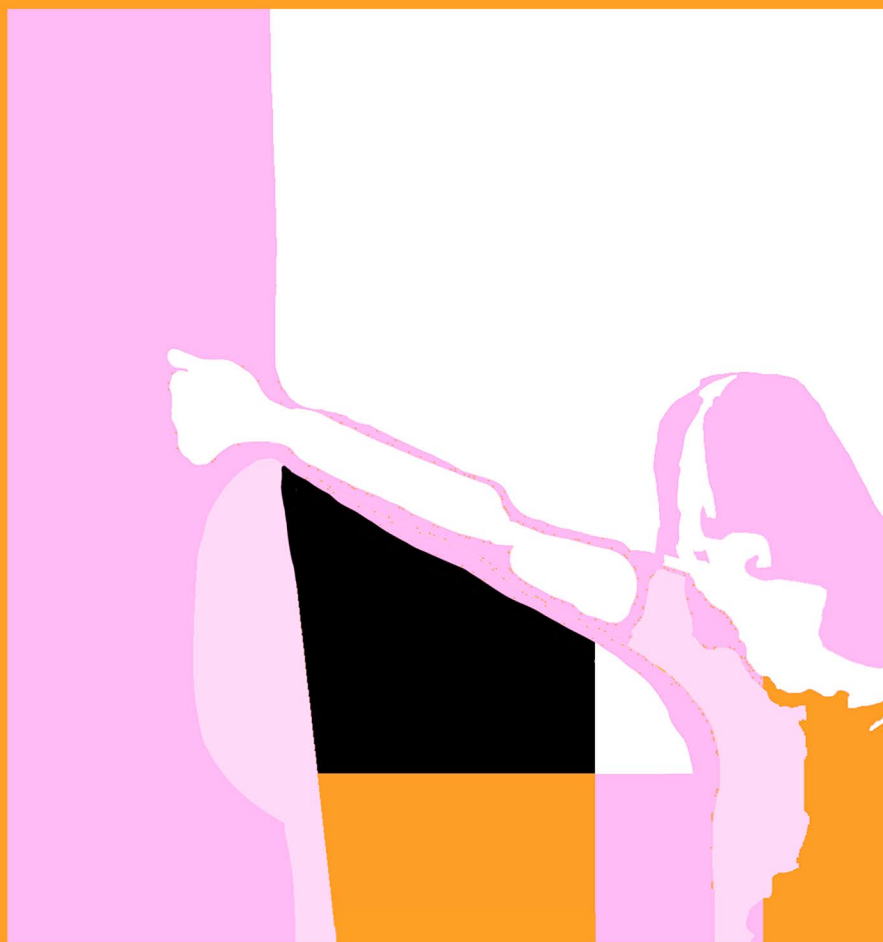
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VIVIAN DOESN'T **DREAM** AGAIN

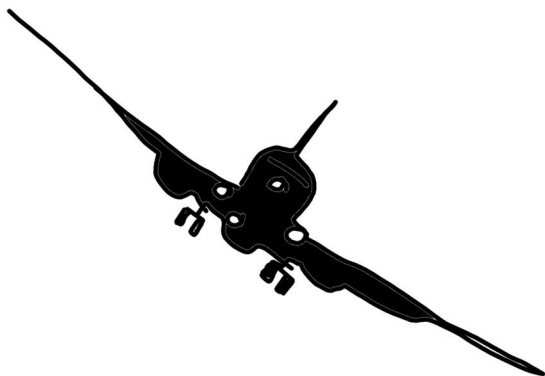




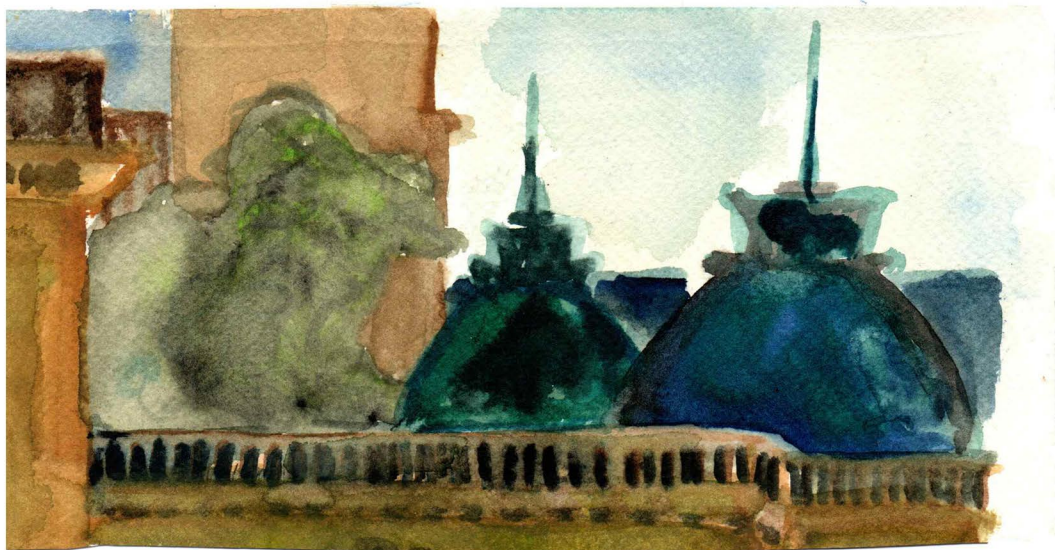


IVY WAKES UP

IT'S 1992, AND IVY IS LEAVING THE UNITED STATES FOR EUROPE.



SHE HAS ENOUGH OF THE PAST TO LAST A LIFETIME.



IT ISN'T THE TRAILING BEHIND THAT BOTHERS HER;

SHE JUST DOESN'T WANT TO SPIN THAT WAY ANYMORE AND TAKES A BRAND NEW MAP OF THE COUNTRY FROM HER POCKET.

